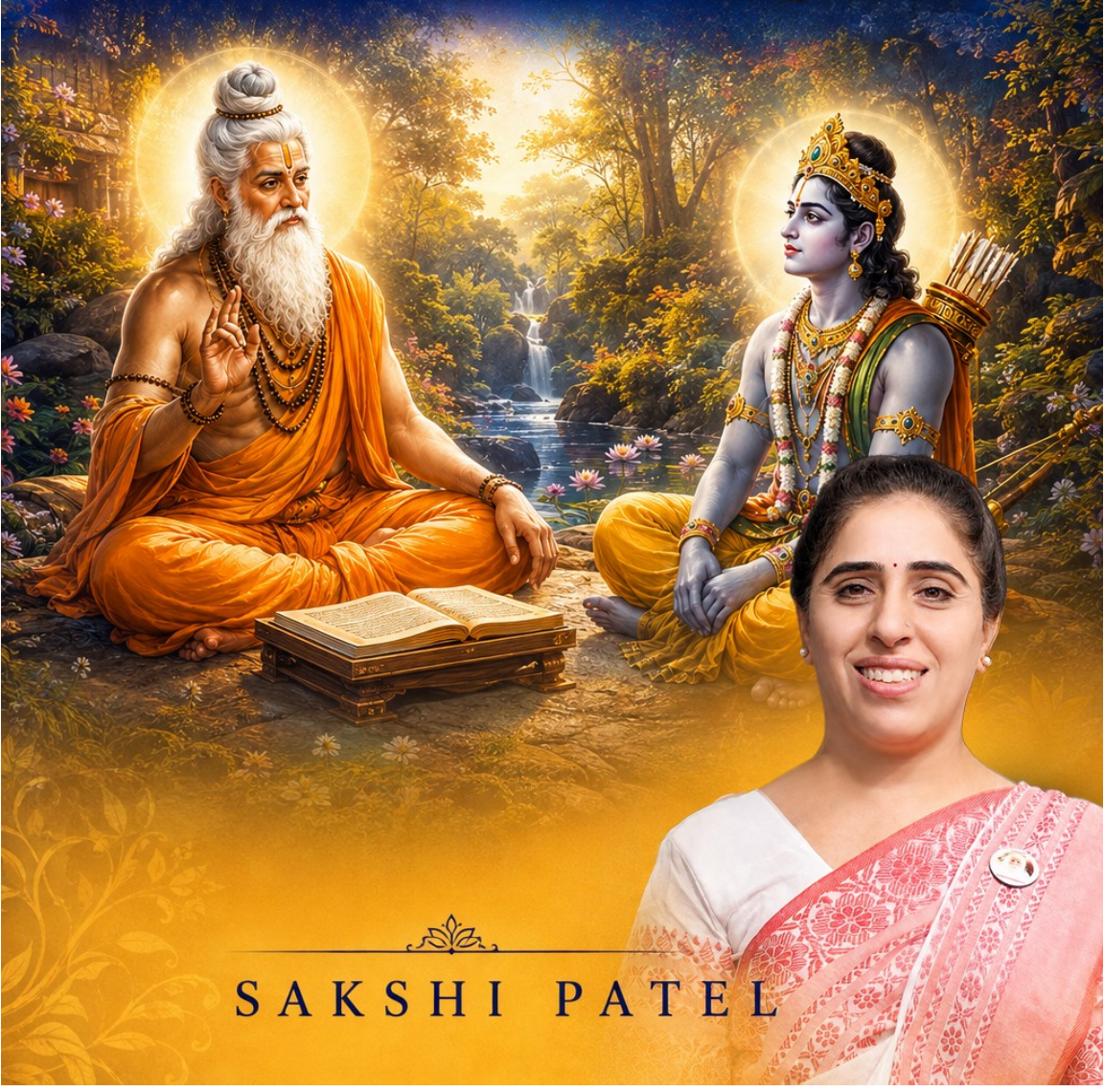


The
**SUPREME
DIALOGUE**
of
VASISTHA and RAMA



SAKSHI PATEL

The Supreme Dialogue of Vasistha and Rama



*A Journey into Self-Knowledge, Non-Duality,
and the Ultimate Truth of Liberation*

S A K S H I P A T E L

Vishwa Parivartak Ishwariya Vidhyalay · Paramshanti

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Gyan Daan Maha Daan
(*Sharing Knowledge is the Highest Charity*)
Share to the maximum extent with all.
— by Bapuji Dashrathbhai Patel

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About Bapuji

Bapuji (full name: Bapuji Dashrathbhai Patel, also lovingly called “Dadaji” by the younger generation) was born in 1956 in the small village of Akhaj in the Mehsana district of Gujarat. However, he spent his childhood in another village named Ambasan, also located in the Mehsana district.

In the early part of his life, he was a highly successful lawyer. Later, he devoted his life to realizing the supreme spiritual truth and bringing this divine knowledge forward for the welfare of humanity. Today, this supreme knowledge serves as a guiding light for true seekers to realize their ultimate destiny.

Despite being raised in a very poor family and facing challenging circumstances, Bapuji had a deep desire to transform this sorrowful and suffering world into a better place. At the young age of six, he questioned God repeatedly, asking why God remained silent about the suffering of humanity. This intense longing to end human suffering eventually led him to attain the highest level of spirituality later in life.

In 1997, he established a spiritual institution called “Vishwa Parivartak Ishwariya Vidhyalay” in Chenpur, Ahmedabad, with the mission of transforming this mortal world, filled with suffering and disorder, into an eternal divine world of immortality. Smt. Sushma Tandon, lovingly known as “Maa,” worked alongside Bapuji in this grand divine mission.

To accomplish this mission, Bapuji worked tirelessly, dedicating all his resources to this divine purpose. During that time, he would deliver continuous spiritual discourses for up to 18 hours without rest. In these discourses, he explained the highest dimensions of divine knowledge, which he realized through deep meditation and divine vision in a state of superconsciousness.

At present, Bapuji remains deeply engaged in intense meditation and *samadhi* for long hours. He does not meet anyone, as he is continuously immersed in his transcendental mission in a superconscious state.

About the Author

Sakshi Patel is a spiritual guide, meditation teacher, and a dedicated contributor to the global mission of spreading divine knowledge. Through her calm presence and clear expression, she has become a guiding force for seekers who wish to understand and experience inner transformation.

She is widely known for her work on the YouTube channel Paramshanti Motivation & Meditation, where she conducts daily guided meditation sessions and shares deep spiritual insights in a simple, practical, and experienceable manner, bridging profound spiritual wisdom with modern life.

With over a thousand live meditation sessions completed, she has consistently guided thousands of seekers toward inner awareness and stability. Her approach brings ancient spiritual wisdom to the needs of modern life, making profound knowledge accessible to a global audience. With a background in MBA (Finance), Sakshi Patel chose to dedicate herself fully to the path of spiritual service. Her journey reflects a shift from external success to inner realization.

Her words are not merely motivational — they are rooted in direct understanding and are meant to awaken deeper awareness within the reader. This collection grows out of her live study of the *Yog Vasistha*, one of the revered *Adhyatmik Granths* (sacred spiritual scriptures) of *Advaita* (non-dual) wisdom, offered here for the newcomer in plain and gentle language.

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Preface

*Gyan Daan Maha Daan — Sharing Knowledge is the Highest Charity. — by Bapuji
Dashrathbhai Patel*

There is an ancient and beautiful *Granth* (sacred scripture) called the *Yog Vasistha*. In it, the wise sage *Vasistha* speaks to the young prince *Ram*, who has grown sad about the world. Through *katha* after *katha* — sacred stories that each carry a teaching — the sage lifts the prince out of sorrow and shows him who he truly is. That one talk has guided seekers for centuries.

The full *Granth* is vast — many thousands of verses. Most people never read it, because its size and its old language can feel like a locked door. These pages are a small key. They gather a few of the most beautiful *kathas* from the *Yog Vasistha*, just as they were shared, class by class, in simple speech — and retell them in easy English for anyone, of any background, who has never opened such a *Granth* before.

You will not need any earlier study. Each chapter tells one *katha* and draws out one clear teaching. Difficult words are written in *italics* and explained the first time they appear; they are gathered again in the Glossary at the end. The chapters in this book are intentionally concise. They are designed to be read one at a time—not hurriedly, but thoughtfully. After each chapter, pause, reflect deeply on its meaning, and allow its spiritual wisdom to settle within your heart and mind before moving on to the next.

One message appears throughout this *Granth*, and wise people have repeated it in every age: do not only read this knowledge — try to live it in your daily life. Even one teaching, when truly followed, can change a person more than reading many books without practicing them. Read these pages slowly. Come back to them again and again. Let the peace found in these words become the peace within your own heart.

May this small offering help you move closer to Param Shanti — the highest peace, which already exists within you.



What Is the Yog Vasistha?

Long ago, a young prince came home from a long journey. He could no longer enjoy his own palace. On his travels he had seen a hard truth: everything in the world begins, shines for a while, and then ends. Kings die. Riches are left behind. Even the sweetest pleasures slip away like sand through the fingers. The prince grew quiet and sad, and nothing could cheer him.

The prince was *Ram*. To lift him out of this sadness, the great sage *Vasistha* began to speak. What the sage said, over many days, became the *Yog Vasistha* — a revered *Adhyatmik Granth* (a sacred spiritual scripture) of *Advaita*, the teaching that all is one. It is not a set of rules. It is a talk meant to wake a person up.

The full *Granth* is huge, with tens of thousands of verses. Wise teachers give simple advice: do not try to drink the whole ocean. Take only what helps you grow, and leave the rest. That is what these pages do.

Six parts of one path

The *Yog Vasistha* has six parts, called *prakaranas*. They are like six steps on one path. The first, *Vairagya*, is about realizing that everything in the world changes and cannot give lasting happiness. The second, *Mumukshu Vyavahara*, is about the sincere seeker who longs to be free. The third, *Utpatti*, is about how the world arises. The fourth, *Sthiti*, is about understanding why the world feels stable and continuous, even though it is always changing. The fifth, *Upashama*, is about calming the mind. The sixth, *Nirvana*, is about full freedom.

You do not need to remember these names. Just feel the shape of the path. First we see that the world cannot give lasting joy. Then we long for something real. Then we learn where the whole show comes from. At last we rest in that source.

The one aim

Under all its *kathas* — its sacred stories — the *Yog Vasistha* has one message. The only road to *moksha* (freedom) is the ending of *moha*: our deep attachment, which clings to temporary things as if they were our very life. Loosen that one knot, and freedom follows. The sage does not tell us to run from the world. He tells us to live fully in it and stay free within.

The awakened ones teach a simple truth: let the dream of the world lose its grip on the mind. When worldly desires and attachments no longer keep drawing the mind back again and again, the first sign of true freedom appears. The world does not disappear; only its power to disturb and bind us fades away. We may still live, work, love, and care for others, yet inwardly remain peaceful, steady, and free.

So, begin gently. Read one *katha*. Sit with it. And remember what the sages say in every chapter: this knowledge is not to be only heard — it is to be lived.

SAKSHI INSIGHT

मोक्ष का एक ही मार्ग है — मोह का नाश।

Moksha ka ek hi maarg hai — moha ka naash.

“There is only one road to freedom — the ending of attachment.”



The Prince Who Saw Through the World

When *Ram* was about sixteen, he asked his father for leave to go on a pilgrimage. He visited holy places, met sages, and spent his days in prayer, giving, and quiet thought. After nearly a year he came home — but he came home changed. A deep *vairagya* (calm dispassion) had settled over him.

What had he seen? He had seen that however great a person becomes, the end is the same for all. Even the mightiest king's body is finally given to the river; people weep for a while, then move on. Everything the world offers is on its way to vanishing. Why, he asked himself, should he give his heart to things that cannot stay?

The sages give a sharp picture. A deer sees a patch of green grass, steps forward to eat — and is caught by the hunter. In the same way, people are pulled by one pleasure after another, step forward, and are quietly swallowed by time.

When his family offered him the usual comforts, *Ram* answered plainly: “These passing things — what use are they to me? I must seek the truth of the Self.” He was not gloomy. He had simply seen that time, once spent, cannot be bought back, and he did not wish to waste it.

Why the teaching began

Around this time, the great sage Vishwamitra came and asked that *Ram* protect a sacred fire ceremony from every threat. *Ram's* father was afraid to send his young son. But the sage *Vasistha* spoke with calm confidence and removed his fear. He said that *Ram's* very presence would be enough to defeat those who wished to cause harm. One who walks the path of truth carries a quiet inner power that changes the atmosphere around him. Such a person may not seek to

conquer the world, yet even difficult circumstances begin to soften, obstacles lose their force, and events gradually turn in his favour.

The two sages saw the prince's sadness and understood it. It was not a sickness to be cured with distraction. It was a readiness to be answered with truth. So, *Ram* was called into the royal court, and there his questions began. From those questions came the whole of the *Yog Vasistha*.

There is a lesson here we can take at once. Sadness at the passing of things is not a mistake. Held rightly, it becomes the door to inquiry. The prince did not turn his dispassion into despair. He turned it into a question — and a sincere question is the start of the way home.

S A K S H I I N S I G H T

जो नाशवान है, उसमें मन क्यों लगाना?

Jo naashvaan hai, usmein mann kyon lagaana?

“Why set the heart on what is sure to perish?”



Two Wings: Knowledge and Action

A seeker once asked a wise sage a question many of us ask: what really frees a person — action, or knowledge? Should we keep doing our duties, or set them aside and only try to understand?

The sage answered with a simple picture. A bird needs both wings to fly. In the same way, we need both *jnana* (true knowledge) and *nishkama karma* (action done without wanting a reward). Notice the important point: it is not enough to act; we must act without being attached to the result. Knowledge without action remains only an idea. Action without knowledge lacks direction. When clear understanding and selfless action come together, they help us grow, become free, and move toward inner peace.

The student who stopped

To explain this clearly, the sage told the story of a young man named Karunya. After studying the scriptures deeply, Karunya suddenly stopped performing his daily duties. His father asked him the reason.

Karunya was confused. The scriptures taught that lasting freedom cannot be gained through wealth, rituals, or family life alone, and that only *tyaga* (inner renunciation) leads to liberation. He did not know what to do. Should he continue his duties, or should he give them up?

Seeing his son's confusion, his father did not argue with him. Instead, he began to answer through another sacred story.

The flaws of heaven

A messenger of the gods was sent to bring a certain king up to *swarga* (heaven). On the way, a celestial maiden asked the messenger a clever question: what are the good points, and the flaws, of heaven itself?

The answer is worth remembering. The sage explained that heavenly happiness is not eternal. A soul enjoys pleasure according to the good actions and merit it has earned. Greater merit brings greater enjoyment; lesser merit brings lesser enjoyment. But even heaven has its limitations. Seeing others in a higher state can create envy. Among those who are equal, there can be comparison and competition. Toward those who are lower, a subtle feeling of pride may arise. Most important of all, heaven does not last forever. When the stored merit is exhausted, the soul returns to the mortal world and takes birth again. Heaven may be wonderful, but it is only a temporary stay, not the final freedom the seeker truly longs for. Heaven is a grand holiday that always ends.

Hearing this, the king refused. “A heaven that ends like that — what would I do there?” He sent the chariot back and returned to his inner practice. And because he now wanted not even heaven, he was led at last toward the one thing that never fades: the knowledge of the Self.

The lesson is quiet and clear. Even the highest reward the world can give is temporary. So we act — we do our duty fully, without grasping — while we seek the knowledge that alone makes us free.

SAKSHI INSIGHT

ज्ञान और निष्काम कर्म — पक्षी के दो पंख।

Gyaan aur nishkaam karma — pakshi ke do pankh.

“Knowledge and selfless action are the two wings of one bird.”



Who Is Ready for This Knowledge?

The Yog Vasistha speaks with great honesty. This wisdom is not meant for a mind that has no longing to understand the deeper truth of life and the hidden mystery of nature. Nor is it meant for the person who already thinks, “I know everything” or “I am fully awakened,” for pride quietly closes the door through which higher wisdom enters.

It is meant for the sincere seeker — the one who feels, “I am still bound, yet I truly wish to know the Truth and become free.”

This simple feeling is a sacred beginning. It contains humility, because it recognizes one’s present bondage. It contains hope, because it trusts that liberation is possible. When such a heart listens with sincerity and receives the truth from a true teacher, the inner journey begins, and the light of awakening can arise with surprising speed.

Three signs of bondage

How do we know that we are still bound? The sage points to three simple signs. First, our happiness depends on people, possessions, success, or other things outside us. Second, we keep searching for lasting joy in things that are temporary and always changing. Third, when a pleasant moment comes, we try to hold it forever, even though everything in this world must pass. As long as these three remain, the mind is not truly free. The sage invites us to see this not with fear, but with honesty. The moment we begin to recognize these bonds, the journey toward inner freedom and lasting peace has already begun.

Three questions to ask yourself

How does the spiritual journey truly begin? The sage asks three quiet but powerful questions.

Do I see that I am not yet fully free?

Do I truly wish to become free?

Do I believe that freedom is possible for me?

These questions are simple, yet they open the whole path. If we do not recognize our bondage, the wish for freedom does not arise. If the longing is weak, the journey never becomes sincere. And if we have no trust in the possibility of freedom, our effort soon loses strength. To answer these questions honestly is already the beginning of awakening.

The sage gives one more practical teaching. Watch the desires that arise in the mind. Gently let go of the many desires that keep pulling the heart toward temporary things. Keep only one deep longing — the longing for truth, for freedom, for union with the Supreme. Such a longing does not bind the soul; it leads the soul toward its highest destiny.

The door to truth is not narrow because truth is hidden. It is narrow because it asks for sincerity. The uninterested mind does not seek. The proud mind does not listen. But the sincere heart that can say, “I am not yet free, but I truly wish to become free,” is already standing at the threshold of liberation.

S A K S H I I N S I G H T

जब तक सुख किसी और पर निर्भर है, तब तक बंधन है।

Jab tak sukh kisi aur par nirbhar hai, tab tak bandhan hai.

“As long as your happiness depends on another, you are bound.”



Free While Living

Here the *Yog Vasistha* gives one of its most hopeful teachings: you do not have to wait for death, or for some far-off world, to be free. There is *jivanmukti* — freedom while still living. A person can walk this earth, do their work, even feel the natural feelings of the heart, and still be free within.

How can a person be free while still living in the world? The sages call such a person a *jivanmukta* — one who is liberated while living. Outwardly, such a person may still smile, grieve, love, speak, and respond to life, because the body and emotions are human. But inwardly, a deep awakening has taken place. Thoughts and feelings may arise and pass, yet they no longer bind the inner being. For such a person, actions continue, but the sense of “I am the doer” has faded away. New chains of karma are no longer created, and the seed of future bondage is not planted again. Beneath all changing emotions there remains a silent, unshaken peace. That inner stillness, untouched by the rise and fall of life, is the true meaning of freedom while living.

The *Granth* gives a striking example. Even *Ram* himself, in his life, grieved the loss of *Sita*; he wept and wandered in search of her. And yet he was a *jivanmukta*. The outer feeling was real, and the inner freedom was also real. The two did not cancel each other. This should comfort us. Freedom does not mean becoming cold or numb. It means staying unshaken under whatever passes across the surface.

Three signs of the free

First, the dream of the world loses its power over him. The world may still appear before his eyes, but it no longer has the same hold on his heart. He sees

that everything is changing and temporary, like the blue sky that appears real to us, though it has no solid substance of its own.

Second, old habits and inner tendencies begin to fade away. Just as snow slowly melts when winter ends, the restless patterns of the mind grow weaker, and a natural peace begins to arise within.

Third, he acts from purity, not from attachment. His actions are guided by truth, compassion, and wisdom, not by selfish craving or the need to possess, control, or hold on.

The roasted seed

The third point becomes clearer through a beautiful image. The sages speak of two kinds of vasana — the hidden desires that live in the mind.

An impure desire is like a living seed. When it is planted, it grows again and again, creating new attachments, new actions, and new bondage. In this way, the cycle of birth and death continues.

A pure desire is like a roasted seed. It may appear the same from the outside, but it has lost the power to sprout. Such desires do not create new bondage. They remain only as much as needed for the present life to continue naturally.

When the body completes its journey, nothing further is left to bind the soul. Those whose desires have become pure are not driven back into the old cycle of craving and bondage. They live in the world, yet remain inwardly free. This is the state of the jivanmukta — free while living, peaceful in the midst of life, and untouched at the deepest level by the changing world.

Never leave the path

One more teaching comes through a beautiful katha. A seeker was given a sacred task by his teacher. The teacher said, “Begin this great work, and no

matter how much difficulty, restlessness, or discouragement arises, do not abandon it until it is completed. Then you will cross the ocean of worldly sorrow as safely as a traveller crossing the sea in a strong ship.”

This teaching is for all of us. The journey towards truth is not always easy. There will be days of doubt, pain, confusion, and inner struggle. Yet the instruction of the sages is simple and powerful: do not give up halfway. Do not drop the goal when the path becomes difficult. Keep walking, keep remembering, keep turning toward the Truth.

Every sincere step has value. And the one who continues with patience, faith, and steadiness will one day reach the far shore — the shore of peace, freedom, and freedom from sorrow.

S A K S H I I N S I G H T

शुद्ध वासना भुने हुए बीज के समान है — वह फिर जन्म नहीं देती।

Shuddh vaasana bhune hue beej ke samaan hai — vah phir janm nahin deti.

“A pure desire is like a roasted seed — it can sprout no new birth.”



The Mind That Wanders Worlds

Now we come to the very heart of the *Yog Vasistha*: the amazing power of the mind. The sage teaches *Ram* that the whole course of a soul follows two things — *vasana* (its hidden desire) and *sankalp* (its firm resolve). Whatever the mind deeply wants and firmly decides, that is the way the being goes. To understand this is to hold the master key.

The wandering of Shukra

There was a great sage, *Bhrigu*, who sat in deep, thought-free absorption on a mountain. His loving son, *Shukra*, watched over him. One day, looking at the sky, *Shukra* saw a celestial maiden pass overhead. Desire stirred. The thought rose, “She must belong to the heavens” — and in that instant his subtle body left his physical body and rose to the heavenly world.

There he lived with her for a very long time. When the merit that had carried him there was spent, they both fell — and then began a long chain of births, driven by desire and action. He was born as this creature and that, in world after world, high and low, again and again. Meanwhile, back on the mountain, his first body slowly wasted to a skeleton, while his father sat on in absorption.

When at last *Bhrigu* woke and found his son’s body dead, he was filled with anger and made ready to curse *Kala* — Time itself, the power of death. And here the deepest teaching is given.

The teaching of Kala

Kala appeared in a fearsome form, yet spoke with perfect calm. “The wise are not shaken even when provoked. I am *Kala*, appointed by the Supreme; I only follow my nature. Do not waste your hard-won merit by cursing me. I devour

all — and you too, in time, are my food. Such is the order of things.” He was neither cruel nor kind. He was simply true.

Then *Kala* turned to the real point — the mind. He gave a set of pictures that unlock everything.

The lake and the moon: when wind stirs the water, the moon’s reflection seems to shake; when the wind is still, the reflection is steady again. Whether the world seems real or unreal to you works the same way — it depends on the movement of your own mind.

The mirror: a mirror is neutral. Whether you call the face in it beautiful or ugly is your mind’s doing, not the mirror’s. In the same way, the mind throws its own judgments onto the body and the world, and then believes them.

Kala went further. It is the mind, he said, that shapes the body with all its senses. When the mind resolves, we call it *buddhi* (the intellect); when it takes itself to be a thing, we call it *ahankara* (the ego). The body is only matter, yet the mind takes it to be its very self. If the mind stops taking itself as the body and walks the path of truth, it reaches the Supreme. Waking, dream, and deep sleep are only the mind’s own play; beyond them lies pure awareness.

The ocean and the waves

Then comes the great picture of the whole *Granth*. The mind is like a vast ocean, and countless waves rise and fall upon it. A small wave thinks, “I am small.” A big wave thinks, “I am big.” A breaking wave cries, “I am being destroyed.” One feels cold, another feels warm — yet every wave is nothing but the one ocean’s water. It is true to say, “There are no waves, only the ocean,” and it is also true to say, “There are waves.” Both are true at once.

So, it is with the endless variety of the universe. It is the play of the one *Parabrahman* (the Supreme). Apart from your own imagining, the

separateness has no real being. As the waves are not other than the ocean, so all things are not other than *Brahman*. This is the settled truth of the teaching.

Hearing this, *Bhrigu*'s eye of knowledge opened. He saw his son's many births in a single moment, and his grief fell away. "Though the world is unreal, it appears real and fools even the great. My son did not truly die. The mind itself is the body." And *Kala* agreed: "True — the mind is a potter. By its own thoughts it makes bodies, and by a mere wish it makes and unmakes them."

The lesson we carry is large but clear. Desire is the rope that ties us to whatever we crave and drags us back into the world. When the desires held in the heart fall away, the mortal becomes free. And the whole show — body, world, high and low — is the making of the mind. Learn to still the mind, and you begin to be free.

S A K S H I I N S I G H T

जैसे लहरें समुद्र से भिन्न नहीं, वैसे ही सभी पदार्थ ब्रह्म से भिन्न नहीं।

Jaise lahrein samudra se bhinn nahin, vaise hi sabhi padaarth Brahm se bhinn nahin.

"As waves are not other than the ocean, nothing is other than Brahman."



As You Think, So You Become

The *katha* of *Abalya* shows the power of the mind in its most vivid — and most serious — form. In a certain kingdom, a man and a woman fell into a total, unbreakable obsession with each other. Wherever each looked, they saw only the other. When the king found out, he ordered them punished with every kind of pain — fire, freezing cold, torment of all sorts.

And here is the strange thing. Their bodies felt almost nothing, because their minds were fixed completely elsewhere, on each other. The punishments could destroy their bodies, but could not touch their minds. So bound were they by that one fixed thought that they were reborn together, again and again, carrying their obsession through life after life.

The sage draws the point at once. If that same total, unwavering love were fixed instead on the Supreme, a person would become divine — would cross birth and death and be free. The very force that binds, turned toward the Real, is the force that frees. The problem is not the strength of the love. It is the direction.

Whatever the mind holds takes shape

From this the deep teaching unfolds. The mind's firm resolve at the moment of death carries into the next birth; the body dies, but the resolve does not, and it presses the soul into a new form to match it. And in life, whatever the mind firmly and steadily dwells upon begins to take shape in one's own experience — so vividly that, as in a dream, it feels completely real, because one has begun to live inside it. This is why the mind's power is called supreme.

There is only one thing that can dissolve such a mind: *atma-jnana*, the knowledge of the Self. Nothing else will do. The mind keeps building worlds,

subtle and gross; to step beyond the world it builds, one needs Self-knowledge. Then, and only then, the restless mind comes to rest in the Supreme.

Two bodies

How could the lovers' minds stay untouched while their bodies suffered? The sage explains that every embodied being has, in a sense, two bodies. There is a mental body — quick, alive, answering in an instant — and a physical body, which does nothing on its own and is frail, silent, and passing, like a dewdrop on a leaf. Curses and blows, praise and comfort, touch only the physical body. The mental body answers only to itself, to its own thoughts. When the mind is confident and set on its aim, sorrow does not reach it; when it rests always in the pure Supreme, it is safe.

The chapter ends with a gentle wonder that shows how far this power reaches. By deep, steady thought the mind can completely change how things feel, until even the false is felt as real: a person sitting in cool moonlight can feel himself burned by heat, and a person standing in blazing sun can feel himself pleasantly cool. Such is the strange nature of the mind. Guard it, then, and give it to the truth — for as is the mind, so is the person.

S A K S H I I N S I G H T

मन जिसका चिंतन करता है, वही मूर्तिमान हो जाता है।

Mann jiska chintan karta hai, vahi moortimaan ho jaata hai.

“Whatever the mind dwells upon takes shape and becomes your world.”



Worlds Born of Resolve

If the last chapter showed the mind shaping a single life, this one shows it shaping whole worlds. The sage gives *Ram* one startling sentence to hold: the soul is made of nothing but *sankalp* (resolve); whatever resolve becomes firm in the heart takes outward form, and every mind carries the power to create a world.

The creation already made

The *katha* begins with wonder. When the creator *Brahma* woke from the sleep that follows a great dissolution and got ready to make the world anew, he found that a creation already existed — before he had made anything. Amazed, he asked how this could be. The answer: not one but ten worlds had arisen, without his making.

The ten who resolved

Here is how. In an earlier age, a pure and worthy couple had ten shining sons. By the age of seven the boys had mastered every scripture. Then their parents left their bodies and passed on. In grief, the ten brothers asked themselves the largest question: what is the highest goal, and how does one escape the endless sorrows of enjoyment? To be a king, or an emperor, or even the lord of heaven seemed a small thing, for such rule lasts only a moment in the vast reckoning of time. So they set their aim on the very seat of the Creator — the one place that lasts to the end of an age. Their understanding reached only this far, and so this is what they chose.

The eldest said, “Then hold this thought: I am *Brahma*, seated on the open lotus.” Each of them then meditated with a mind made completely one-

pointed: “I am the creator; all the powers and worlds are within me; now creation arises; now it continues; now it dissolves; I am the Self, and I am free.”

Their bodies wasted away and were gone. Yet in their bodiless state they held, without wavering, to the single thought “I am the Creator” — through the fierce dissolution and on into the new dawn. And their resolve held true. They became creators, each of a whole cosmos, ten worlds in all, each with its own sun. That is why *Brahma* found a creation already made.

The mind is the maker

When *Brahma* asked what was left for him to do, the answer completed the teaching. “You have no craving and no purpose; you need do nothing. As the sun shines without any resolve, and a lake reflects it without wishing to, so this creation arose from you without your desire. What the mind makes does not perish; only physical things perish. A person becomes whatever truth is firmly fixed in his mind — that alone is truly there for him. The mind alone makes the world; the mind is supreme. What the mind does is real action; what the body does is not. See its power: by firm meditation these souls became makers of whole worlds. And when a person thinks himself a lowly, helpless mortal, he becomes exactly that.”

The lesson to carry home both humbles and frees us. Creation itself is, at root, a work of mind. A firm resolve, held with a one-pointed heart, takes form. So the most important thing we can do is choose the resolve we hold — and hold, above every other, the highest one: “I am the pure, eternal Self.” The body follows the mind; the mind follows the intellect; the intellect follows the Self. Fix your resolve at the source, and everything below it comes into order.

S A K S H I I N S I G H T

जीव केवल संकल्पमय है।

Jeev keval sankalpmay hai.

“The soul is made of nothing but its own resolve.”



The Great Doer, Enjoyer, and Renouncer

A humble, shining sage once came to Lord *Shiva* with a beautiful question: by holding what inner conviction can a person live at ease in this fragile house of the world, free of every worry, and stand unshaken? And what makes someone a great doer, a great enjoyer, and a great renouncer? *Shiva's* answer is a portrait of the free human being — active in life, yet fully at peace.

The great doer

The *Mahakarta* (great doer) is free of pride, of wrongdoing, and of envy. He is thoughtful, and he does his proper duties without worry. He fixes his affection nowhere, and stays unchanged like a witness. Whether things are being born, continuing, or ending, his mind stays even. In the words of the *Gita*, this is the *sthitaprajna*, the one of steady wisdom — the person who acts fully and is still within.

The great enjoyer

The *Mahabhokta* (great enjoyer) hates nothing and craves nothing. He simply meets whatever destiny brings — pleasant or unpleasant — with the same even heart. Free of ego and settled in the Supreme, he takes things through the senses yet does not truly take; he acts yet does not act; he enjoys yet does not enjoy. The picture is the ocean: as the sea receives the waters of every river alike, clean or muddy, so he receives all pleasures and pains alike, and is neither lifted nor troubled by them.

The great renouncer

The *Mahatyagi* (great renouncer) has, with clear discernment, given up the pleasant and the forbidden, pleasure and pain, birth and death; all desires, all doubts, all the restless efforts of speech, mind, and body; and at last the whole

visible world that the mind has imagined. Having laid down even that, he is the great renouncer.

Shiva draws these three together into one truth. The ever-shining, spotless, beginningless and endless *Parabrahman* alone truly is; nothing at all exists apart from *Brahman*. All that appears is the work of imagination; the single root of it all is the changeless Supreme — vast through countless creations, yet formless like space. Nothing, however gross or subtle, can be other than the one *Brahman*. “Therefore know,” he says, “that I am that *Brahman*.”

How to master the mind

And he leaves a method we can really use. To master the mind, wherever it runs, see that object as unreal — and give yourself every reason for its unreality. Just as we do not chase the dream-body once we have woken, treat the waking world as fleeting and unable to hold you. Do this, and the mind slowly turns away from the passing and toward the Real, the imperishable *Brahman*. Come to rest in the Self, and the restless mind is won. This is not a call to leave the world. It is a way to stand within it — as doer, as enjoyer, as renouncer, all at once — and stay free.

S A K S H I I N S I G H T

ब्रह्म से अतिरिक्त कुछ भी नहीं है।

Brahm se atirikt kuchh bhi nabin hai.

“Nothing whatsoever exists apart from Brahman.”



Grief and the Thousand Kin

This chapter meets us where sorrow is most human: the loss of those we love. By a river there once lived a sage with his wife and two sons, *Punya* the elder and *Pavana* the younger. *Punya* had come to true Self-knowledge. *Pavana*, though no longer fully ignorant, had not yet gained the real knowledge of the Supreme.

In time the old sage, his years complete, gave up his body in perfect peace and merged into *Sacchidananda* — Being, Consciousness, and Bliss. His wife, by the method he had taught her, soon followed. *Punya*, being Self-knowing, did the last rites unmoved. But *Pavana*, lacking that knowledge, was overcome with grief and wandered the forest, weeping for his parents.

The comfort of *Punya*

Punya came to his grieving brother and spoke words that have comforted seekers ever since.

“Grief-delusion is the one true cause of sorrow — why cling to it? Our parents have reached the deathless state of *Sacchidananda*, which is the very nature of everyone. And they were not only your parents. As every forest holds countless streams, so you have had thousands of mothers and thousands of fathers across your many lives; and each of them had countless sons; you were never their only child. As countless waves rise and vanish on a river, so countless children of countless beings are born and are quietly taken by time.”

“If grieving for parents out of love is right,” he went on, “then why not grieve without end for the thousands of parents of your past lives? For whom shall we weep, and for whom shall we not? Look deeper, *Pavana*. From the highest view, you were never truly born; you have no mother and no father to lose; you are only the pure, awakened Self, and nothing else. This body is a heap of blood,

flesh, and bone; who am I apart from it? ‘This is *Punya*, this is *Pavana*’ — even these are ideas we have taken as real.”

The lamp, and the fire

Punya gave two pictures to steady his brother. First, the lamp: a lamp is present where light is joined, and yet it is itself doing nothing. In the same way the Self-knower, free of the pride of “I am the doer,” acts in the world’s dealings and yet stays a non-doer. He works, but he is not caught in the working.

Second, the fire: the one cure for our countless cravings is not to feed them, but to let them go. As a fire grows higher the more wood you add, so worry grows the more the mind dwells on its enjoyments; and as a fire dies for want of fuel, so worry dies when the mind stops dwelling on things. Take discernment and a clear, quiet mind as your only companions, and you will not be broken even in hardship. By dispassion, by study, and by patience, kindness, peace, evenness, and contentment, a person lifts his own mind — and when the mind is dissolved, that steady one reaches the supreme, deathless state.

The words did their work. *Pavana* woke to the highest realization, and in time both brothers, having lived out their days, reached the supreme *nirvana*. And the teaching that healed them can heal us: to the awakened, the whole world is a waking dream. The wise do not fret over the past, which is already a dream, nor over the future, which is only imagining. They rest in their own true nature, and are at peace.

SAKSHI INSIGHT

तृष्णा की एकमात्र निवृत्ति है त्याग — इंधन डालने से आग बढ़ती है।

Trishna ki ekmaatra nivritti hai tyag — indhan daalne se aag badhti hai.

“The only cure for craving is letting go — adding fuel only feeds the fire.”



The Hungry Demoness Who Became a Knower

One of the most surprising *kathas* in the *Yog Vasistha* is the tale of *Karkati*, a *rakshasi* (demoness) — for it shows that even the most unlikely being can be turned toward the truth. On the northern slopes of the mountains lived a huge and fearsome *rakshasi* named *Karkati*, dark as the night, so vast that her form seemed to fill the space between earth and sky. Her hunger was her torment: her appetite was so great that nothing she ate was ever enough.

So she made a plan. “If I could swallow every living creature with each breath, as the ocean swallows the rivers, then at last my hunger would be stilled — and there is no joy greater than the ending of hunger.” To gain the power to devour all beings, she climbed to a lonely peak and did fierce *tapasya* (austerity), standing on one foot, unmoved through heat and cold, for a thousand years.

Ram wondered aloud how so wicked a being could win such grace. The sage answered with a rule worth keeping: strong austerity bears its fruit by its very nature — when *tapasya* is perfected, even poison-fire turns cool; nothing is beyond its reach. The fruit follows the effort, not the character of the one who makes it.

The folly of the needle

When she got her wish, *Karkati* asked for a special power: to become so tiny and invisible that she could slip inside any living being — entering through their very breath — like a fine needle. In this hidden form, she could quietly eat away at the world from within.

The wish was granted, but with one important rule: she could only harm people who were undisciplined and evil — those living a messy, wrongful life. She

could never touch good, virtuous people. And even if she tried, a good person could drive her away simply by saying a short prayer.

And now came the twist. She had her subtle form — but her hunger grew worse, not better. Now she had no belly at all, and depended completely on others for her food. The sage gives a perfect picture of a craving that defeats itself: it is like a man running, out of breath, toward a mirror to see his own face — only to fog the glass with his own breath, so that he sees nothing. When we are ruled by craving, good sense dies, and we rush headlong into our own ruin.

The turning

At last *Karkati* saw her folly, and wept. “For this I did a thousand years of *tapasya*? I threw away my mountain-form and chose this needle. I am not even free — I am moved about in others’ hands. The cure has proved worse than the disease.” And the moment the realization struck her, she at once gave up the wish to devour all beings, and returned to the mountains.

This is the turning point of the whole story. It shows that no matter how old or deep a habit is, just one moment of true understanding — real, clear knowledge — is enough to break it completely, instantly. Our patterns are not chains of iron; they change through knowledge. What holds us back is not that change is impossible, but that we lack the confidence to begin.

She sat again in *tapasya* — but this time with every craving already laid down. Her being was made completely pure, and she woke to the highest knowledge. She had found the answer within herself: one’s own consciousness is the supreme teacher that knows every movement of thought, and beyond it there is nothing. When the Creator offered her a boon, she had no wish left to ask.

The questions of the demoness

By the natural order she took her old form again, now as a knower, and was charged to awaken the minds of the ignorant. One night, in a forest, she met a

king and his minister on their rounds. She roared, “Who are you? Answer, or I will devour you.” The minister, not afraid at all, replied with calm: seeking food is natural, but one must not be proud even in one’s natural work; the wise avoid anger and act with a cool, open mind; and whether or not one reaches one’s aim, one should stay even-minded. “Ask what you wish,” he said. “We have never sent even a beggar away empty.”

Impressed, *Karkati* put to them a long string of riddles — questions that all point to one answer. What is that which is one, yet also many, into which countless universes dissolve? What is active, yet does no action? What is still as a rock, yet is conscious? What shines though it is neither sun nor moon nor fire? What is smaller than the smallest atom, yet holds even mountains within it, and turns the three worlds into a single blade of grass? What is that from which the seer, the seeing, and the seen all arise?

The one answer

The minister — now speaking to her with respect, for such questions can rise only in a mind ready for truth — gave the answer that is the summit of this *Granth*. “That to which all your questions point is the *Param Atma*, the Supreme Self. It is subtler than the subtlest space; it has no name, no colour, no form; neither mind nor senses can reach or hold it, for it is beyond them. It is pure consciousness.”

“The whole cosmos rests within it as a great tree rests within a tiny seed; at dissolution the world abides in it as consciousness, not as world. Consciousness alone ever is, for it is the one experiencer and the Self of all — so that what is outside is the very same as what is within. Though it is one, it is reflected through the countless atoms of creation and so appears as many; but that appearance is unreal, as a bangle imagined in gold is unreal. The gold alone is real. As the pot is passing and the clay is what truly is, so all forms pass and *Brahman* alone remains.”

The king completed it. “It is understood only when the movement of thought in the mind comes to rest. And when knowledge itself reaches its end, its expression is silence — for it is beyond every expression. Subtler than a hundredth part of the tip of a hair, it is yet greater than the greatest, because it is everywhere. The light of Self-knowledge alone lights up every experience: that inner light appears as outer light and shows us the outer world. In the blink of an eye one may live a whole age within it — as, in a short dream, one may live through youth, old age, and even death. So the Self itself neither acts nor is touched; consciousness alone acts, and is present to all experience. The world was never truly created, and is never truly destroyed.”

Hearing these wise words, *Karkati* grew calm, and her demonic nature fell away. “O wise ones,” she said, “those who keep the company of the wise never suffer in this world — just as one who holds a lamp in his hand never sees darkness.” At the king’s request she took the form of a gentle woman and lived after that as his guest, troubling only the wrongdoers he sent her, and harming as little as her nature required.

The sage closed the *katha* for *Ram* with its whole meaning. Know that the cosmos arises from *Brahman*, and that *Brahman* is alone. Cause and effect, self and Supreme, difference and non-difference, knowledge and ignorance, pleasure and pain — all such pairs are only made up to teach the not-yet-awakened. They are not true in themselves. In the end, all divisions are unreal, and only the one infinite consciousness remains.

S A K S H I I N S I G H T

जिसके हाथ में दीपक है, उसे कभी अंधकार नहीं दिखता।

Jiske haath mein deepak hai, use kabhi andhkaar nahin dikhta.

“One who holds a lamp never sees darkness.”



Self-Effort and the Refusal of Heaven

The last of our *kathas* is about *purushartha* (self-effort) — and about a sage who reached the Supreme by his own sincere striving. His name was *Uddalaka*. Having decided with a clear and steady mind, he sat in *padmasana* (the cross-legged posture), his eyes half-closed, and set himself to meditate.

The first thing he did tells us something honest and useful. Like a great elephant tied to a post, he bound his five senses within the body. For this is where everyone must begin, however learned: even great sages do not find the mind and senses obedient at first. The senses run out toward their objects like restless animals, and the first task of meditation is simply to bring them home and hold them still. Then *Uddalaka* worked to make his nature clear and pure, like a flawless autumn sky, and to enter the deepest, thought-free absorption.

The lamp in a windless place

From that absorption he gained *tattva-jnana* (the knowledge of Reality). Freed of the endless choices of the perceived world, he merged into the eternal, infinite *Paramatma*, the very ground on which the world rests. In that state he became like a lamp set in a windless place — its flame completely still. He was motionless as a painted figure, deep as a waveless ocean, silent as a cloud that has spent all its rain. And so settled, a long time passed.

The powers that came like toys

Then the temptations arrived. Wondrous *siddhis* (special powers), so great they could grant the rank of the lord of heaven or of the sun, came crowding around him, with celestial beauties in attendance. But *Uddalaka* looked on these powers as a child looks on toys, and gave them no importance at all — for his mind was free of every ripple and his intellect was deep. Ignoring them, he

stayed for six months in that ocean of bliss, and there he reached *jivanmukti*, freedom while living. The reaching of the Supreme, the sage tells us, is the highest state — the most peaceful goal, the eternal and blessed ground of all good.

The refusal of heaven

When he finally came out of his deep meditation, he found a magnificent gathering waiting for him — glowing, divine beings bowing before him, and rows of heavenly chariots lined up. They said to him, "Great one, come with us! Climb aboard and travel to swarga, to heaven — the highest place of all worldly pleasure and joy. Come enjoy the delights you wished for, for age after age. After all, isn't the whole point of doing austerities to earn the reward of heaven?"

Uddalaka received his guests with courtesy — and then sat perfectly unmoved. He neither welcomed the celestial powers nor pushed them away in scorn; he simply stayed indifferent, said only, "You may go," and returned to his meditation. The heavenly host bowed to this sage who had no craving left in him, and then departed. All who had come to carry him up to heaven went away empty-handed. As one free while living, *Uddalaka* wandered happily wherever he wished, through forests and the hermitages of sages, and lived in the mountain caves in quiet meditation.

So what does this teach us? The sages call the state he reached "param shanta gati" — the state of supreme peace. Once someone reaches this state, nothing around him — however dazzling — can pull him away or excite him anymore. He becomes free inside, detached — not sad or gloomy, just calm and content. He may continue to live among people and take part in everyday life, but deep inside he carries **peace and bliss**. He knows that what he has found within cannot be given to him by any person, object, or worldly pleasure. And having a "deep intellect" simply means having a mind so filled with true understanding

that there's no space left for anything else. So when any temptation comes — no matter how tempting or shiny it looks — he turns it down easily, without any inner struggle. Why? Because he has already seen through it and understood its real worth: nothing.

So the *katha* ends with the quiet instruction that runs through this whole *Granth*: knowledge is not merely to be heard, but to be lived. Give this very life to the reaching of the Supreme. Do not put it off to some other day or some other birth — for who has seen the next? What you are seeking is not far away. It is the peaceful ground on which you already stand.

S A K S H I I N S I G H T

ज्ञान केवल सुनने का नहीं, जीने का है।

Gyaan keval sunne ka nahin, jeene ka hai.

“Knowledge is not to be merely heard — it is to be lived.”



The Journey Home

We began with a sorrowful prince who had seen through the world, and we have followed the sage's answer through many *kathas*. It is worth gathering, at the end, the few great threads that run through them all — for they are simple, and they are enough.

First, there is one aim, and one road to it. The aim is *moksha* (freedom from sorrow); the road is the loosening of *moha*, our deep attachment to passing things. We are not asked to flee the world, only to stop clinging to it as if it were our very life. Live fully; hold lightly.

Second, the mind is the door. The *Yog Vasistha* returns to this again and again. The mind is the potter that shapes our bodies and our worlds; whatever it firmly dwells upon takes shape; the soul is made of its own resolve. This is why the whole path can be called the mastering of the mind. And the way to master it is gentle but steady: wherever the mind runs toward some passing thing, see that thing as fleeting, as unable to hold you — and the mind slowly turns back toward the Real.

Third, there is the nature of the world and the Self. The *Granth* says it plainly: the world is *mithya*, an appearance like a dream, seeming real yet never lasting; and *Brahman*, pure consciousness, alone truly is. As the waves are not other than the ocean, and the bangle is only gold, so all things are not other than the one Reality. And that Reality is not far off in the sky. It is your own innermost Self — subtler than the subtlest, yet nearer than your own breath. What is outside is the very same as what is within.

Fourth, freedom is possible now. We do not have to wait for death or for a far world. *Jivanmukti* — freedom while living — is real. Feelings may still move

across the surface of a free person, as they did even for *Ram*; but underneath is a stillness that nothing can break. That stillness is *Param Shanti*, the supreme peace, and it is already your nature.

What, then, is left to do? Only to walk. Take the tools the sages give: *viveka*, the discernment that tells the real from the unreal; *vairagya*, the calm turning-away from what is passing; *vichara*, sincere self-inquiry; and steady practice, which is like an ant that climbs, slips, and climbs again, until at last it reaches the top. A single teaching, truly lived, will do more than a whole library merely read.

And so we come back to where the prince began, but now with light instead of sorrow. Everything you have chased will pass. The one who is chasing will not. Beneath the wandering mind and the changing world, quiet and unbroken, is the awareness by which you know anything at all. That is the truth these *kathas* have been pointing to from the first page.

You are not this passing body. You are not even this restless mind. You are the infinite consciousness — and coming to know that, and to live it, is the journey home.

S A K S H I I N S I G H T

यह जगत को इस तरह भुला दो कि वह फिर स्मृति में न आए।

Yah jagat ko is tarah bhula do ki vah phir smriti mein na aaye.

“Let the world-dream be so forgotten that it never rises in memory again.”

Glossary

A gentle guide to the Sanskrit and Hindi words used in these pages. Each is written simply, in the sense in which the *Yog Vasistha* uses it.

Advaita “Not two.” The teaching that only one reality exists — pure consciousness — and that all separateness is appearance.

Adhishthana The underlying support or ground on which an appearance rests, as the rope is the ground of an imagined snake.

Adhyatmik Granth A sacred spiritual scripture.

Ahankara The ego; the sense of “I am this body, this name, this doer.”

Akasha Space or sky; often used as an image for that which is everywhere yet holds nothing back.

Antahkarana The “inner instrument” — the mind, intellect, memory, and ego taken together.

Apsara A celestial maiden; a being of the heavenly worlds.

Atma The Self; one’s true nature, which is pure consciousness — not the body, mind, or feelings.

Brahman The one infinite Reality; pure being–consciousness, the source and substance of all that appears.

Buddhi The intellect; the faculty that decides, discerns, and understands.

Chetana Consciousness; the living awareness by which everything is known.

Chitta The mind-stuff; the field of thought, memory, and impression.

Drishtanta An illustrative example or comparison used to make a teaching clear.

Granth A sacred scripture or holy text.

Guna A quality of nature. The three are *sattva* (clarity), *rajas* (activity), and *tamas* (inertia).

Jagat The world; the whole moving show of names and forms.

Jivanmukti Freedom while still living. A *jivanmukta* is one who is free even while in the body.

Jnana Knowledge; especially the direct knowledge of the Self.

Kala Time; also pictured as the power that devours all things.

Katha A sacred story that carries a spiritual teaching.

Karma Action, and the fruit that action brings.

Maya The mysterious power by which the one appears as many; the play of appearance.

Mithya Neither wholly real nor wholly unreal; an appearance, like a dream, that seems real yet has no lasting being.

Moha Delusion; the deep attachment that mistakes the passing for the true.

Moksha Freedom; release from sorrow and from the cycle of birth and death.

Mumukshu One who sincerely longs for freedom.

Nirvana The final peace; the state of complete freedom.

Nishkama Karma Action done without craving its reward.

Padmasana The cross-legged “lotus” posture used for meditation.

Param Atma The Supreme Self; the one consciousness that is the innermost Self of all.

Param Shanti Supreme peace; the deep, unshakable peace that is the Self’s own nature.

Parabrahman The Supreme Brahman; the highest Reality beyond all form.

Prakarana A section or part. The *Yog Vasistha* has six *prakaranas*.

Pralaya Dissolution; the drawing-in of the whole universe at the end of an age.

Purushartha Self-effort; sincere personal striving toward the goal.

Rakshasa / Rakshasi A demon or demoness; a fierce, unruly being.

Ram The prince to whom the *Yog Vasistha* is taught; an ideal of the awakened human being.

Sacchidananda Being–Consciousness–Bliss; a threefold pointer to the nature of *Brahman*. Also *Sat-Chit-Ananda*.

Samadhi Deep meditative absorption in which the mind grows still and one-pointed.

Sankalp Resolve; a firm intention or mental determination that shapes experience.

Siddhi A special power gained through austerity or yog.

Sthitaprajna One of steady wisdom, unmoved in pleasure and pain.

Swarga Heaven; a realm of great but temporary enjoyment, earned by merit.

Tapasya / Tap Austerity; sustained inner discipline and effort.

Tattva-jnana Knowledge of Reality; the direct realization of the truth of things.

Tyaga Renunciation; the inner letting-go of craving and attachment.

Upakhyana An illustrative episode told to convey a teaching.

Vairagya Dispassion; the calm turning-away from what is passing.

Vasana A latent tendency or subtle desire carried in the mind.

Vasistha The sage who teaches *Ram* in the *Yog Vasistha*.

Vichara Sincere self-inquiry; steady reflection on what is real.

Viveka Discernment; the clear power to tell the real from the unreal.

A Note on the Source

The *kathas* retold in these pages are drawn from the *Yog Vasistha* (also called the *Yog Vasistha Maharamayan*), studied class by class by Sakshi Patel on the YouTube channel Paramshanti Motivation & Meditation. The aim throughout has been to stay close to what was actually taught: the *kathas*, their comparisons, and their conclusions belong to the *Granth*; only the language has been made simple.

The *Yog Vasistha* is very large. Readers who wish to go further may look for a good shorter edition of the *Granth* for wider study. These pages are not a translation or a scholarly edition; they are a doorway, meant to make a few of the *Granth*'s most shining teachings easy to meet for the first time.

To watch the original classes, visit the Paramshanti Motivation & Meditation channel on YouTube.

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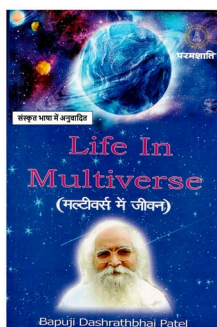
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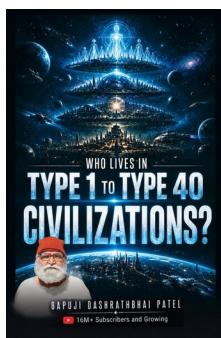
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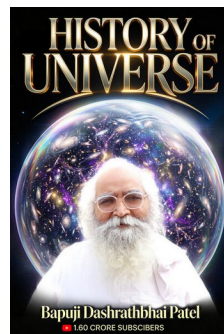
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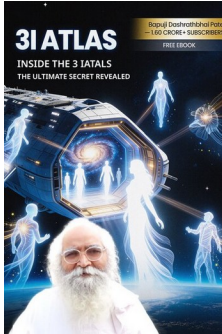
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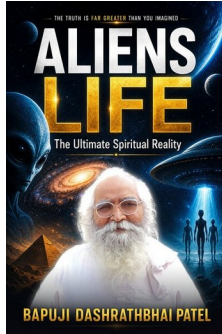
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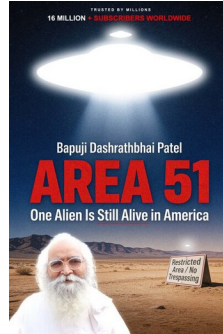
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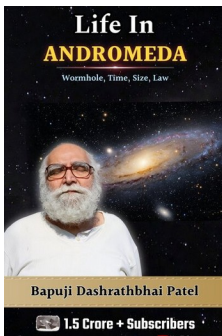
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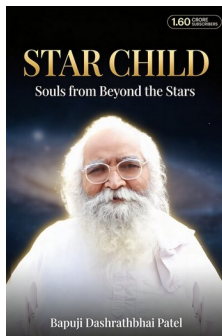
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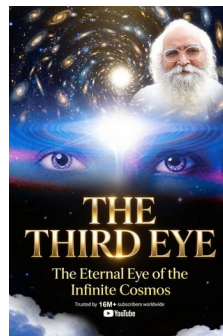
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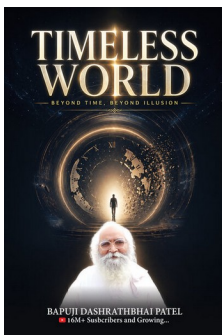
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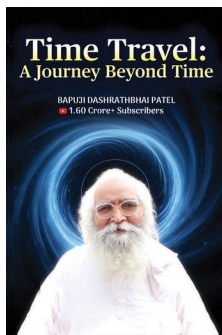
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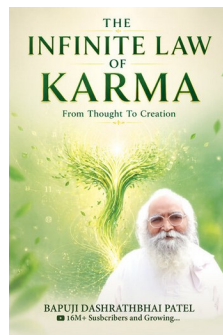
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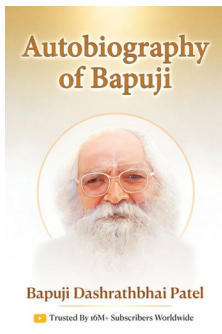
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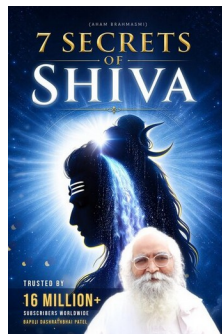
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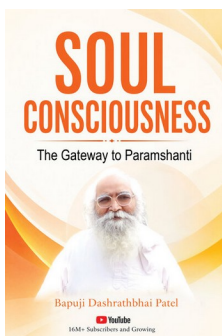
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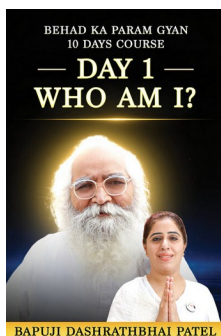
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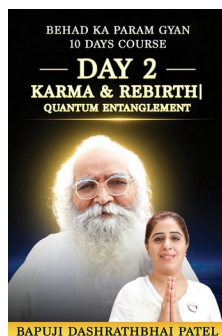
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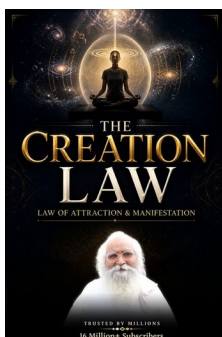
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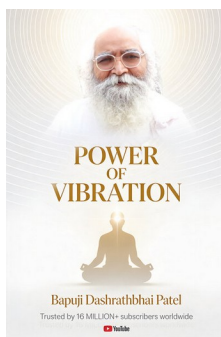
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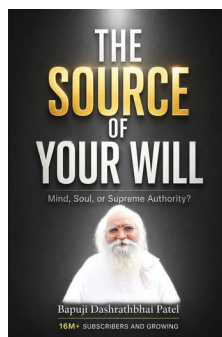
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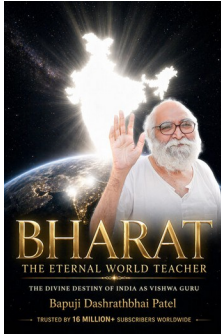
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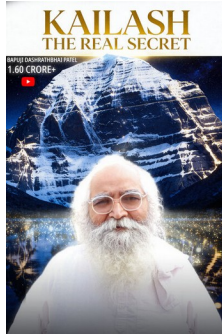
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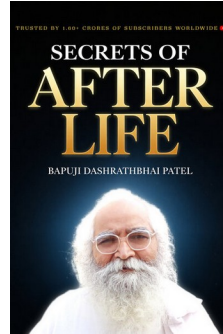
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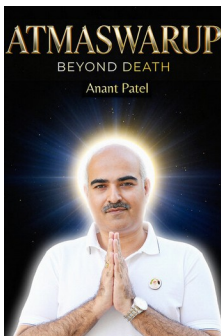
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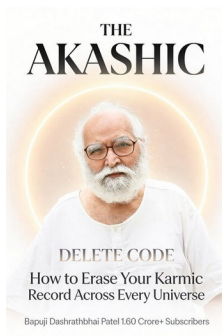
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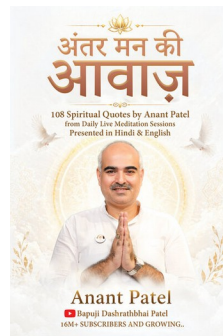
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